



Out of this world



Fewer than 600 people have traveled into space. The first astronauts, known as cosmonauts in Russia, orbited Earth in tiny, one-person space capsules. Later astronauts traveled to the Moon, and to orbiting space stations, where they could live and work.

In 1961, Yuri Gagarin became the first spaceman, with a 108-minute flight in the cramped 7-ft 6-in (2.3-m) capsule of a **Vostok 1** spacecraft. A month later, the USA sent Alan Shepard into space on board **Mercury**. Until space stations were built, early manned missions were short.